

Leave Policy

Version: v1.2

Date: March 2026

Document ID: PD-003

1. Purpose

This policy outlines the procedures and guidelines for requesting, approving, and managing leave within the organisation. It is designed to ensure that employees are able to take time off when needed while maintaining business continuity and operational efficiency.

The organisation recognises the importance of work-life balance and aims to provide a fair and consistent approach to leave management for all employees and consultants.

2. Scope

This policy applies to all employees, consultants, and contractors who are required to request and manage leave through the company's internal systems.

It covers all types of leave offered by the organisation and applies regardless of working location, including office-based, remote, and client-site roles.

3. Types of Leave

The organisation provides a range of leave options to support employees in different circumstances.

3.1 Annual Leave

Annual leave is paid time off that can be used for holidays, personal commitments, or rest. Employees are allocated a set number of days per year.

3.2 Sick Leave

Sick leave is provided when an employee is unable to work due to illness or medical reasons. Supporting documentation may be required for extended absences.

3.3 Compassionate Leave

Compassionate leave is granted in situations involving serious personal circumstances, such as bereavement or family emergencies.

3.4 Unpaid Leave

Unpaid leave may be requested where no other leave type applies. Approval is subject to business needs and management discretion.

3.5 Remote Working

Remote working may be requested as an alternative to leave, where appropriate. This must be agreed in advance with a line manager.

3.6 Other Leave

Additional leave types, such as maternity, paternity, or religious observance, may be available in accordance with organisational policies and legal requirements.

4. Leave Request Process

All leave requests must be submitted through the company's internal portal. Employees are responsible for ensuring that their requests are accurate and submitted within a reasonable timeframe.

The process includes:

- selecting the appropriate leave type
- entering start and end dates
- providing a brief reason for the request
- submitting the request for review

Once submitted, the request is automatically sent to the employee's line manager for approval.

5. Notice Period

Employees are expected to provide adequate notice when requesting leave. As a general guideline:

- Annual leave should be requested at least five working days in advance
- Longer periods of leave should be requested with additional notice
- Emergency leave should be communicated as soon as possible

Failure to provide sufficient notice may result in the request being declined.

6. Approval Process

All leave requests are reviewed by the employee's line manager. Approval decisions are based on:

- team availability
- workload and operational requirements
- timing of the request
- fairness across the team

Managers may approve, reject, or request further information before making a decision. Employees will be notified of the outcome through the system.

7. Leave Balances

Employees are responsible for monitoring their leave balances. The system provides an overview of:

- total leave allocation
- leave used
- remaining leave

Employees must ensure that they do not exceed their allocated leave unless explicitly approved.

8. Changes and Cancellations

If an employee needs to modify or cancel an approved leave request, they must update the request through the system or inform their manager as soon as possible.

Changes are subject to approval and may not always be possible depending on operational requirements.

9. Unauthorised Leave

Leave taken without approval is considered unauthorised. This includes:

- failing to submit a request
- taking leave before approval is granted
- exceeding approved leave periods

Unauthorised leave may result in disciplinary action.

10. Sickness Reporting

In the case of illness, employees must inform their manager as soon as possible, ideally before the start of the working day.

For extended periods of sickness, employees may be required to provide medical evidence or follow additional reporting procedures.

11. Manager Responsibilities

Managers are responsible for:

- reviewing leave requests fairly and consistently
- ensuring adequate team coverage
- maintaining records of leave approvals
- communicating decisions clearly

Managers should also support employees in balancing work responsibilities with personal needs.

12. System Usage

All leave requests must be recorded within the company's system. This ensures accurate tracking and transparency.

Employees should not rely on informal communication alone (e.g. verbal approval or messages) without submitting a formal request.

13. Compliance

All employees must follow the procedures outlined in this policy. Failure to comply may result in:

- leave requests being denied
- records being flagged for review
- disciplinary action where appropriate

14. Policy Review

This policy will be reviewed periodically to ensure it remains aligned with organisational needs and legal requirements.

Updates will be communicated to all employees, and the most recent version will be available through the company portal.